EMERGING IT TRENDS

AI, IoT & Cloud Computing

A look at where artificial intelligence, connected devices, and cloud infrastructure are headed — and what it means for organizations today.

2026 Industry Outlook

OVERVIEW

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THE BIG PICTURE

Why These Trends Matter Now

AI, IoT, and cloud computing are no longer separate technologies — they're converging into a single foundation for how modern organizations operate.



Artificial Intelligence

The reasoning layer — turning raw data into predictions, decisions, and automated action.



Internet of Things

The sensing layer — billions of connected devices generating real-world, real-time data.



Cloud Computing

The infrastructure layer — the scalable compute and storage that makes it all possible.

Artificial Intelligence Overview

Artificial intelligence enables systems to perform tasks that normally require human reasoning — recognizing patterns, generating content, and making decisions.

Generative AI produces new text, images, and code, while agentic AI goes further — planning and executing multi-step tasks with less human input.

- **Recognizes patterns in data**
- **Automates repetitive work**
- **Generates content & code**
- **Supports human decisions**



Key Concepts

- Machine Learning — systems that learn patterns from data
- Generative AI — creates new text, images, audio, or code
- Agentic AI — plans and executes multi-step tasks autonomously
- Large Language Models — power most modern AI assistants

WHAT'S NEXT

AI Trends to Watch

Agentic AI

AI agents that plan, act, and complete multi-step tasks with growing autonomy.

Physical AI & Robotics

Intelligence moving off the screen and into robots, drones, and smart equipment.

Domain-Specific Models

Smaller models tuned for a single industry, offering higher accuracy and compliance.

Multiagent Systems

Multiple specialized AI agents collaborating to handle complex, multi-part tasks.

Efficient Model Design

A shift from simply scaling models to building smaller, hardware-aware ones.

Trust & Governance

A growing focus on measurable outcomes, oversight, and responsible deployment.

IMPACT

AI by the Numbers

$2.5T

Forecast global spending on AI in 2026 (Gartner)

83%

Of organizations already using or experimenting with AI

11%

Of organizations have AI agents in production, vs. 38% piloting

The pilot-to-production gap is the story of 2026: most organizations are experimenting with AI, but few have scaled it into everyday operations.

Internet of Things Overview

A network of physical devices — sensors, machines, vehicles, appliances — that collect and exchange data over the internet.



Sense

Sensors capture real-world data — temperature, motion, location, and more.



Connect

Devices transmit data over Wi-Fi, cellular, or low-power networks.



Process

Data is analyzed on the device (edge) or sent to the cloud for deeper insight.



Act

Systems respond automatically — adjusting, alerting, or triggering an action.

Common applications include smart homes, connected vehicles, industrial monitoring, and smart-city infrastructure.

WHAT'S NEXT

IoT Trends to Watch

Edge AI & AIoT

AI models running directly on devices for instant, offline decision-making.

Digital Twins

Continuously updated virtual models of physical assets, fed by live IoT data.

Zero-Trust Security

End-to-end encryption and authentication built in across the device lifecycle.

Interoperability

Shared standards that let devices from different vendors work together.

Industrial IoT

Sensor-driven automation across manufacturing, energy, and logistics.

Smart Cities

Connected traffic, utilities, and public services optimized in real time.

IMPACT

IoT by the Numbers

21B+

Estimated IoT devices deployed worldwide today

$1.35T

Global IoT market size estimated for 2025

$74–99B

Global AI-in-IoT (AIoT) market value in 2026

Most of today's IoT devices still rely on external processing — the shift toward on-device AI is just beginning.

FOUNDATIONS

Cloud Computing Overview

On-demand access to computing power, storage, and software over the internet — without owning the underlying hardware.



IaaS

Infrastructure as a Service — rented servers, storage, and networking.



PaaS

Platform as a Service — ready-made environments for building and running apps.



SaaS

Software as a Service — ready-to-use applications accessed over the web.

WHAT'S NEXT

Cloud Trends to Watch

Hybrid & Multi-Cloud

Most enterprises now split workloads across multiple providers by default.

AI-Native Architecture

Cloud platforms built around elastic compute and GPU orchestration for AI.

FinOps & Cost Control

Growing discipline around tracking and optimizing cloud spend at scale.

Sovereign Clouds

Data residency and compliance driving region-specific cloud deployments.

Edge-Enhanced Cloud

Processing pushed closer to users and devices for lower latency.

Sustainable Data Centers

Rising energy demand is pushing providers toward greener infrastructure.

IMPACT

Cloud Computing by the Numbers

$918B

Global cloud market size
in 2026 — crossing $1T soon

94%

Of enterprises use
cloud services in some form

68%

Combined market share of
AWS, Azure & Google Cloud

AI-related workloads now make up about 19% of total cloud spending in 2026, up from just 8% in 2023.

THE BIGGER PICTURE

How AI, IoT & Cloud Converge

Together, they form a continuous loop — from real-world sensing to intelligent, automated action.



IoT Devices

Sensors and machines collect real-world data

Edge Processing

Initial analysis happens close to the device

Cloud Infrastructure

Data is stored, aggregated, and scaled

AI Models

Patterns are found and predictions are made

Automated Action

Systems respond, adjust, or alert in real time

STAYING GROUNDED

Challenges & Considerations



Security & Zero Trust



Data Governance



Cost Management



Skills Gap



Energy & Sustainability



Vendor Lock-In

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Convergence Is the Real Trend

AI is moving to production

The gap between piloting and scaling AI is 2026's defining challenge for most organizations.

IoT is getting smarter

Intelligence is shifting from the cloud to the edge, enabling faster, more autonomous devices.

Cloud is the shared foundation

Nearly all enterprises now run on the cloud — the question is how to run it well.

Thank You

Questions & Discussion